NavigSA Logbook Reflection

Introduction

This logbook covers the week of 28 to 31 July 2026, when our team moved the NavigSA project from a design idea to a development-ready plan. NavigSA is managed with Scrum, a framework where a team builds a product in short, planned cycles called sprints instead of doing everything at once. We tracked our work on a Trello board, a digital board with columns (Product Backlog, In Progress, Completed) that shows who is doing what. This week was the preparation stage, and it taught us that planning properly is a real part of software development.

Body

The week began on Tuesday 28 July, when we presented our NavigSA Figma prototype to the lecturer and the class. Figma is a design tool for drawing a website's screens before any code is written. We demonstrated the planned layout and user flow, which is the path a user takes through the site. Presenting helped us see the project through other people's eyes. The feedback showed us that our Product Backlog (the master list of everything the product needs) did not yet follow Scrum standards. Our logbook says: "Some backlog items needed to be restructured to match Scrum standards." That was uncomfortable at first, but it was useful, because we found the problem before development started rather than halfway through it.

On Wednesday 29 July, we acted on that feedback. We updated the Trello Product Backlog and rewrote the items as user stories. A user story describes a feature from the customer's point of view, for example "As a user, I want to ... so that ...", so the team builds what people need and not just what is technically interesting. We also put the items in priority order, added detailed subtasks, and assigned responsibilities to team members. The main obstacle was that some items needed team confirmation before they could be finalized. We learned that in a group project nobody can finish a backlog alone, because the priorities have to be agreed by everyone.

On Thursday 30 July, we reviewed the backlog together and finalized the order of the high-priority items. We also identified which user stories would go into Sprint 1 and confirmed who was responsible for each. We checked that the Figma prototype still matched the planned backlog items, so that design and plan told the same story. This was where teamwork became very visible. Our impediment that day was that final sprint estimates needed input from every member. An estimate is a guess of how much effort a task will take, and it is only reliable if the people doing the task take part in making it.

On Friday 31 July, we completed Sprint 1 planning and finalized the Sprint Backlog, the smaller list of tasks chosen for this one sprint. We reviewed Trello to confirm the items were organized correctly and prepared the project for development. The walkthrough section of

our logbook shows the board accurately reflected our work. When asked "Is anyone working on anything that is not on the board?", our answer was no. This showed us that a board is only useful when it is honest and up to date.

The impediment that kept returning all week was that we were awaiting final confirmation from all team members before development could begin. This taught us that a project can be delayed by waiting for communication even when the technical work is ready. In Scrum, the Daily Scrum (a short daily team meeting) is where blockers are raised, and we plan to use it actively and not stay quiet about problems.

Conclusion

One of the things that this work showed us is that good software starts well before the first line of code. Presenting the prototype, restructuring the backlog, writing user stories, and planning Sprint 1 gave our team a clear direction. Our main lessons were to accept feedback early, to keep the Trello board accurate, and to communicate blockers quickly. In the next sprint we want to update our task statuses regularly, raise problems in the Daily Scrum as soon as they appear, and make sure every team member understands their responsibilities.